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Hiring Team
Sea Sentinel AI
Leopoldstrasse
Munich

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Application for Founding Backend & AI Engineer

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Founding Backend & AI Engineer position at Sea Sentinel AI. I have a Master's in Artificial Intelligence and three years of experience building and deploying AI applications, most recently as the sole developer of a production LLM pipeline where I owned prompts, evaluation and delivery.

Your posting asks for people who treat model behavior as something to measure. At Kniit I worked that way. The pipeline extracted knowledge from complex regulatory documents with parallel LangGraph agents, and I tuned prompts against a ground truth derived from SAP systems. Precision and recall went from 33% and 45% to 93% and 90%. When one change fixed a case and broke another, the ground truth showed it. I also replaced an LLM-based extraction for a second, high-volume source with deterministic code, which took a projected $200,000 LLM budget to near-zero running cost. In my Master's thesis at Covestro I built the evaluation side of a RAG system with RAGAS and PytrecEval against chemist-provided answers, and benchmarked multilingual embedding models on more than one million chunks.

On the engineering side, I write Python backends with FastAPI and Docker and have deployed them on Azure at Kniit. At Covestro I deployed an agentic application to AWS with CDK, so infrastructure as code is familiar, although I have not used Pulumi or SST. I have not run a news-scale monitoring setup like PRISM either; my tracing and alerting experience is from smaller pipelines, and I would want to learn how you handle silent failures at 800,000 articles a day.

What draws me to Sea Sentinel is the problem itself. Finding a vessel incident in a local newspaper before the major media do, and having customers act on it through an API, is work with visible consequences. I like the idea of owning a system end-to-end, working directly with the founders and deciding which new model capabilities are worth adopting, and then proving that with evals. Extending PRISM into air cargo and energy fits my background from the German energy sector.

I am based in Munich, hold an EU Blue Card and can start on 1 January or earlier. Thank you for considering my application. I would be glad to walk you through the Kniit pipeline: what broke, how I knew it worked, and what I would do differently.

Kind regards,

Chandu Prasad Bhairapu